



Running the server as a container

The published image is `registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server`, tagged `latest` and the commit short sha. It is a distroless static binary — **8.6 MB**, no shell, running as `nonroot`.

This document records the first real deployment, on vault2, 2026-09-05.

What this deployment proved, that nothing had proved before

The multi-arch CI job verifies the image config's architecture and the ELF machine type of the binary inside. Both are checks on *bytes*. Until this deployment **the published image had never actually been run** — not by CI, not by anyone. It now has:

```
library indexed songs=22 distinct_charts=22 duplicate_packages=0 problems=0 took=7ms
listening addr=:8080 songs=/songs data=/data version=827e0fe
```

`version=827e0fe` is how you know the image is the commit it claims to be.

It also moved the server off the development machine for the first time. Every earlier measurement was `127.0.0.1`, which cannot fail in any of the ways a real network can.

The deployment

```
# on the host
mkdir -p /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/songs \
        /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data
chown -R 65532:65532 /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data

docker run -d --name yarg-song-server \
  --restart unless-stopped \
  -p 8099:8080 \
  -v /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/songs:/songs:ro \
  -v /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data:/data \
  registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server:latest
```

Three things there are not decoration:

- `chown 65532`. The image is distroless and runs as `nonroot`, uid 65532. `/data` holds the on-demand pack cache and must be writable by that uid or the server starts fine and then fails the first time somebody asks for a song that is stored as anything but a `.sng` — a loose folder, a `.zip` or a `.7z`, all of which are packed on demand. `/songs` stays root-owned and is mounted `:ro`, because the server never writes to the library and should not be able to.
- `/mnt/cache/...`, not `/mnt/user/...`. An absolute pool path, not the shfs union. This host has a documented history of SQLite-on-FUSE corruption, and `/mnt/user` was **99% full** at deployment (568 GB of 29 TB) while the cache pool had 1.4 TB free.
- `-p 8099:8080`. 8099 was free; the container listens on 8080 internally. Checked against `ss -ltn` rather than assumed — this host had 59 containers running and 76 ports already in LISTEN.

Registry authentication

The host's stored credential was stale and `docker pull` failed with `unauthorized: HTTP Basic: Access denied`. A GitLab personal access token with the `api` scope works for a registry pull — measured; `read_registry` is the documented scope but was not required here.

Log in without putting the secret in `argv`, where `ps` would show it:

```
docker login registry.badassium.com -u <user> --password-stdin <<'ENDTOK'
<token>
ENDTOK
```

The token comes from 1Password at run time and is never written to a file, a commit, or this document.

End-to-end result, 2026-09-05

Step	Result
Pull and start on vault2	running, 0 restarts, indexed 22 songs in 7 ms
GET /healthz from the host	200
yarg-sync from ENG-1 over Tailscale	22 downloaded, 0 failed, 229,515 bytes in 341 ms
Byte count vs the localhost run	identical — same archives, different machine
Second sync	0 downloaded, 22 already present, 0 bytes , 19 ms
Unmodified YARG on the synced folder	20 accepted, 2 refused

The two refusals were the same two, for the same reasons, as every earlier run — `no notes found` and `no audio accompanying the chart file`, both independently flagged by our own scanner.

The client reached the server by its **Tailscale name**, not a LAN literal, so the same command works from anywhere ENG-1 happens to be. A `192.168.2.x` address would have worked at the time of the test and failed from the office.

The pack cache bound, verified here rather than in a test

`pack_cache_max` shipped with six red-proofed tests and did not work. Every test inserted, so every test reached eviction through the insert path; this deployment's cache was already full, every request was a hit, nothing was ever packed, and the bound was never enforced. Deploying it found that in under a minute.

After the fix (`6bcf4ec` , enforce at start as well as on insert), running deliberately tight at **102,400 bytes** against a library that packs to 229,515:

Moment	Cache
Before restart, from the broken build	229,515 bytes, 22 archives
Immediately after start, having served nothing	67,681 bytes, 6 archives
After serving all 22 songs	67,681 bytes, 6 archives
Songs the client received	22 of 22, 0 failed

Three things in that table, in order of importance:

- The cache dropped from 22 archives to 6 **before a single request arrived**. That is the start-up enforcement, and it is the case the tests all missed.

- It stayed at 6 while serving 22 songs, so eviction kept pace with insertion rather than merely happening once.
- **Every song was still delivered and verified.** Sixteen of the twenty-two had to be re-packed mid-sync because eviction had removed them, and the client — which re-derives each song's identity from the bytes it receives — accepted all of them. That is the concrete evidence that eviction costs a re-pack and never data.

The conclusion drawn from that third bullet was too strong, and the number in it was a clue nobody read. "Eviction costs a re-pack and never data" is true; "and therefore the re-packed archive is the same archive" does not follow, and was false. Those same sixteen songs came back with *different bytes* — the packer drew a random mask per call — which the client could not notice, because it verifies the chart's identity and the chart is copied byte for byte. Identity survived; the archive did not. The next day the same sixteen turned up as sixteen SHA-256 mismatches between two machines, and that is what named the defect. Fixed on 2026-09-06 by deriving the mask; [docs/TEST-CORPUS.md](#) has the run. **A client that verifies identity will accept a byte stream that a cache, an ETag and a Range resume all require to be stable — so client acceptance is not evidence of stability.**

What this still does not prove

- **~~arm64 has never been executed.~~ Closed 2026-09-06.** Both the cross-compiled arm64 binary and the published arm64 container image ran on a Raspberry Pi 4 Model B Rev 1.5 ([aarch64](#) , Debian 13 trixie), each indexing the 22-song corpus in about 25 ms, and the archives they served were byte-for-byte identical to every x86-64 sync. See [docs/TEST-CORPUS.md](#) , "The ARM leg". Note the caveats there: it was a Pi 4 rather than the 3B+ (that board is dead), the machine was one-shot and wiped, and the image was transported by [docker save / load](#) rather than pulled directly on the Pi.
- **~~The Phase 2b exit criterion needs two clients.~~ Closed 2026-09-06.** YARG was installed on r7-desktop and both machines were scanned: 20 accepted, 2 refused on each, the same two songs. Doing it is what found the determinism defect above — see [docs/TEST-CORPUS.md](#) , fourth oracle run.
- One library, 22 songs, 224 KB. Nothing here says anything about a real collection's size or scan time.

Re-deployed 2026-09-06 on [c623dae](#) , and what it proved beyond the fix

Every number above was taken from a server that packed with a random mask ([6bcf4ec](#) was running; an earlier revision of this document said [827e0fe](#) , which was the deployment before it). Pipeline 2259 published [c623dae](#) and the host was re-pulled:

```
docker pull registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server:latest
docker rm -f yarg-song-server
rm -rf /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data/packs # start with an empty cache on
purpose
docker run -d ... # identical arguments to the first
deploy
```

The stored registry credential from 2026-09-05 was still valid, so no fresh login was needed. Wiping the pack cache first is deliberate: every archive is then packed by the new binary, and nothing served afterwards is a leftover of the random-mask era.

```
library indexed songs=22 distinct_charts=22 duplicate_packages=0 problems=0 took=11ms
pack cache bounded max_bytes=2147483648
listening addr=:8080 songs=/songs data=/data version=c623dae
```

Then five independent syncs were compared file by file:

Client	Server	Result
ENG-1	ENG-1, built from the working tree (windows/amd64)	reference
ENG-1	same, after wiping the whole pack cache	identical
r7-desktop	ENG-1's server	identical
ENG-1	the vault2 container (linux/amd64)	identical
r7-desktop	the vault2 container (linux/amd64)	identical

110 archives, two client machines, two servers built for different operating systems and by different toolchains, and one deliberate cache wipe — all one set of bytes. **The derivation is not platform-dependent**, which the fix needed to be but which nothing had shown until this run. Unmodified YARG on the container's output: **20 accepted, 2 refused**, the same two songs.

Worth stating plainly because it is the standard this project holds: the last row of that table is an identity established by hashing every file, not by arguing that identical inputs must give identical results.

Re-deployed 2026-09-06 on [423902b](#) , with archive ingest

The library on the host was replaced with the 23-case corpus, which includes [23-zipped.zip](#) — a song delivered as an archive rather than a folder — and the pack cache was wiped so nothing served afterwards was a leftover of the previous image.

```
library indexed songs=23 distinct_charts=23 duplicate_packages=0 problems=0 took=9ms
listening addr=:8080 songs=/songs data=/data version=423902b
```

Check	Result
<code>/version</code>	<code>423902b</code>
<code>/healthz</code>	200
The archive-sourced song in the catalog	<code>name="Zipped"</code> , <code>source_path="23-zipped.zip"</code> , 0 issues
<code>yarg-sync</code> from an empty folder	23 downloaded, 0 failed, 238,215 bytes in 399 ms
Every archive vs the locally built server	23 / 23 identical

That last row is the container-independence property crossing a build platform: the song the **linux/amd64 container** ingested from inside a `.zip` is byte-identical to the one a **windows/amd64** build produced from the loose folder. Nothing about the container it arrived in, or the machine that packed it, reaches the bytes a client receives.

The host's stored registry credential was still valid, so no fresh login was needed.

Re-deployed 2026-09-06 on `077f36e` , and the hostile-archive fix measured on the real thing

Pipeline 2278 published `077f36e` (archive-ingest hardening). Two things were worth measuring here that a test cannot reach: whether a code change altered the bytes a client receives, and whether the new "this archive is unreadable" report actually arrives where an operator would see it.

`latest` was confirmed to be the commit before it was run, not assumed:

```
docker pull ...:latest
docker pull ...:077f36eb          # note EIGHT characters - CI tags with CI_COMMIT_SHORT_SHA
docker image inspect ...:077f36eb --format '{{.Id}}'  # same image id as :latest
```

That the tag is eight hex characters and the git short sha is seven is a small trap: a `:077f36e` pull fails with `manifest unknown` , which reads like a missing image rather than a mistyped tag. `GET /api/v4/projects/53/registry/repositories/14/tags` lists what exists.

Nothing about a code change reached the bytes

The pack cache was hashed **before** the upgrade, wiped, and hashed again after the new binary had re-packed all 23 songs:

```
sha256sum *.sng | sort -k2 > /tmp/packs-423902b.txt  # before
# ... pull, rm -f, rm -rf data/packs, docker run ...
sha256sum *.sng | sort -k2 > /tmp/packs-077f36e.txt  # after
diff /tmp/packs-423902b.txt /tmp/packs-077f36e.txt  # no output
```

Check	Result
<code>/version</code>	<code>077f36e</code>
<code>/healthz</code>	200
Index	23 songs, 23 distinct charts, 0 problems , 9 ms
23 archives re-packed on a wiped cache, vs the <code>423902b</code> cache	byte-for-byte identical
<code>yarg-sync</code> from ENG-1 over Tailscale	23 downloaded, 0 failed, 238,215 bytes in 312 ms
The 23 files the client received, hashed, vs the 23 packs on the server	identical set

The determinism property now holds **across a code change**, which is a different claim from the ones already recorded — those compared machines, operating systems and architectures at a fixed commit. Byte-stability across upgrades is what a client's `ETag` and `Range` resume actually depend on in practice, since a server gets upgraded far more often than it changes CPU.

The silently-ignored song, reproduced and then observed being reported

`077f36e` exists because a zip written with **backslash** separators used to disappear from a library with no message. A probe archive was built to be exactly that shape — `song.ini`, `notes.mid` and `song.ogg` under `Backslash Song\`, written with the separator stored verbatim — dropped into the host's library, and the server restarted.

Building the probe is itself instructive. Python's `zipfile` rewrites `os.sep` to `/` in `ZipInfo.__init__`, so `ZipInfo("Backslash Song\\song.ini")` silently produces a *forward* slash and the probe proves nothing; the name has to be assigned after construction. And `namelist()` normalises backslashes when reading back, so the file looks wrong even when it is right — the only honest check is to count `0x5C` bytes in the file itself. **Both the writer and the reader hide the thing being tested**, which is the same shape as the defect: a convenient view of an archive is not the archive.

```

level=INFO  msg="library indexed" songs=23 distinct_charts=23 duplicate_packages=0
problems=1
level=WARN  msg="could not index" path=24-backslash.zip
           err="scan: archive contains a song.ini or a chart but no song folder could be
read
           from it; if it was made by an old Windows tool it may use backslash path
           separators - re-zipping it will fix that"
```

It appears in `/api/v1/library` under `problems` as well as in the log, so an operator with no shell on the host still sees it. Before this commit the same file produced `problems=0` and no mention anywhere.

The probe was removed afterwards and the library restored to the 23-case corpus — a permanent `problems=1` would make every future index report ambiguous. `0 problems`, `restarts=0`, health 200 at the end.